

Content Map (Original Long Version)

Not including vocab, target language, etc.

(Formatted for one-page quick references)

Telephone Content Map 1: Table of Contents

List of Goals:

Goal 1) Start and Finish Phone Calls

Goal 2) Handle Basic Call Types: Hold, Connect/Transfer, Wrong Numbers

Goal 3) Take and Leave a Message

Goal 1) Start and Finish Business Calls

1. Receptionist Starting Phrases:
2. Caller Starting Phrases:
3. Receptionist Finishing Phrases:
4. Caller Finishing Phrases
 - 4.1 The call is not ending yet:
 - 4.2 End now:
5. Company Goodbye Phrases:
6. Caller Goodbye Phrases:

Goal 2) Handle Basic Call Types: Hold, Connect/Transfer, Wrong Numbers

- 1) Caller:
 - 1.1) Calling phrases:
- 2) Receptionist:
 - 2.1) Getting through (Including: When a receptionist forgets or confirms caller's information.)
 - 2.2) Transfer (Including: When someone is not available and when a transfer is not working.)
 - 2.3) Hold (Including: When the caller wants to try again later.)
 - 2.4) Wrong Number
- 3) Variations:
 - 3.1) Getting through (Variation) *Receptionist forgets or confirms caller's information:*
 - 3.2) Transfer (Variation) *When someone is not available*
 - 3.3) Transfer (Variation) *When a Transfer is not working:*
 - 3.4) Hold (Variation) *Caller wants to try again later*

Goal 3) Take and Leave a Message

1) Taking a Message

- 1.1) When possible refer to the person by their name (if you have it, can pronounce it, and can remember it) .
- 1.2) Telling caller the person they wish to speak with is not present
- 1.3) Answer a question about when the person will be back.
- 1.4) Telling them when you are ready to take the message.
- 1.5) Getting and Checking the data.
- 1.6) Tell them you will deliver the message.
- 1.7) Hang up last.

2) Leaving a Message

- 2.1) Asking to leave a message:
 - 2.2) Asking when the person will return. Checking if you need to leave a message or call back:
 - 2.3) Identify yourself: your name, company
 - 2.4) State the topic of the call. (e.g. placing an order, meeting, travel, etc.)
 - 2.5) State your message
 - 2.6) Common Messages
 - 2.7) No message: you wish to call back
 - 2.8) Get receptionist to repeat back your message to check it
 - 2.9) Give your clients and customers the email option.
 - 2.10) Say thank you
 - 2.11) Hang up first
-

The aim of this Text/lesson:

The purpose of this unit is to actually teach the goal-skills regarding English language phone calls to students by breaking the topic into specific skills and language, then using the understand-practice-use system to work the student towards mastery of this content. This UT should cover all basic call making and call receiving skills.

The purpose of this unit is not phone-flavored free conversation or general language skills.

(Unit Name) Making and Receiving Phone Calls

List of Goals:

Goal 1) Start and Finish Business Calls

Goal 2) Handle Basic Call Types: Hold, Connect/Transfer, Wrong Numbers

Goal 3) Take and Leave a Message

Specific content for each goal:

Goal 1) Start and Finish Business Calls

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1. Receptionist Starting Phrases:
2. Caller Starting Phrases:
3. Receptionist Finishing Phrases:
4. Caller Finishing Phrases
 - 4.1 The call is not ending yet:
 - 4.2 End now:
5. Company Goodbye Phrases:
6. Caller Goodbye Phrases:

Receptionist Starting Phrases:

A + B + C

Example: Hello, this is Otsuka Pharmaceutical. My name is Ken Fujita. What can I do for you today?

A

- Hello, this is (Company).
- (Company), thank you for calling.
- Thank you for calling (Company).

B

- (Name) speaking.
- This is (name).
- My name is (name).

C

- What can I do for you today?
- How may/can I help you today?
- What can I help you with today?

Caller Starting Phrases:

- (Yes) Hello. This is (Name). I am calling from (Company) in (Country).
- (Company)'s (Name), here.
- Hello. (Name) from (Company) here.
- Hello. (Name) here. I am calling from (Company) [in (country)].
- Hello, this is (Name) from (Company) [in (Country)].

Receptionist Finishing Phrases:

- Is there anything else I can help you with today?
- Will there be anything else?
- (Do you need) anything else?
- Will that be all?
- Is that all you need?
- Do you require any other/further assistance?

Caller Finishing Phrases

The call is not ending yet:

- Can you...
- I would like to know...
- Yes, could you tell me...
- (Just) One more thing...
- Can you tell me...

End now:

- (No) That's all. Thank you very much for your time.
- (No) Nothing else. Many thanks.
- That's it. You have been very help, thank you very much.
- No, thank you very much.
- Yes, that's all. Thank you very much.
- That's everything. Thank you very much for your help.

Company Goodbye Phrases:

- Goodbye, thank you for calling. (company name optional).
- Thank you for calling. Goodbye.
- Goodbye, have a great day.

Caller Goodbye Phrases:

- Goodbye. Take care.
- Have a nice day. Goodbye
- Thank you very much for your help.
- Thank you for your time. Goodbye.

Remember: Wait for the caller to hang up first.

Goal 2) Handle Basic Call Types: Hold, Connect/Transfer, Wrong Numbers

Caller:

- 1) Calling phrases:

Receptionist:

- 1) Getting through (Including: When a receptionist forgets or confirms caller's information.)
- 2) Transfer (Including: When someone is not available and when a transfer is not working.)
- 3) Hold (Including: When the caller wants to try again later.)
- 4) Wrong Number

Variations:

- 1) Getting through (Variation)Receptionist forgets or confirms caller's information:
- 2) Transfer (Variation)When someone is not available
- 3) Transfer (Variation)When a Transfer is not working:
- 4) Hold (Variation)

Partner A) (Caller)

1 Calling: When a caller asks to speak with someone:

(No other situations for the caller)

I would like to speak with X (please).

May/Can/Could/Might I (please) speak with/to X (please). [E.g. Can I please speak with Mr. Robbert Johnson in sales?]

X please.

Could you (please) transfer me to X (please).

Could you (please) connect me to/with X (please).

Is X in?

Is X there?

Is X available?

I am trying to find X.

I am looking for X.

I was hoping to speak with X.
Can I have extension 321?
Extension 321 (please).

Partner B) (Receptionist)

- 1) Getting through (Including: When a receptionist forgets or confirms caller's information.)
- 2) Transfer (Including: When someone is not available and when a transfer is not working.)
- 3) Hold (Including: When the caller wants to try again later.)
- 4) Wrong Number

1) Getting through: the caller will speak with you or someone near you.

- I can help you with that. (You can probably answer their question.)
- here he/she is. (a person near you, you hand them the phone.)
- this is he, this is she. (if they are asking for you by name or position.)

2) Transfer

- Just a moment.
- Here he/she is.
- I am connecting/transferring you now.
- Would you like me to transfer you (now)?
- Just a moment, let me transfer you....
- I'll put you through (now)...

3) Hold

(Note: Ask permission first.)

May I put you on hold?
Can you hold (on) a moment?
Please hold on just a moment.
Just a moment.
One Moment.
Just a sec.
Hold on a sec.
One minute.
Wait a sec.
Please wait a minute.
Wait a minute.
Just a minute.

4) Wrong Number

It is certainly the wrong number: I'm sorry, you have the wrong number.
It is likely the wrong number, or you are being polite: I'm sorry, I think you have the wrong number.
Uncertain/Maybe the wrong number: I'm sorry, (I think) you may/might have the wrong number.
Who/(What number) were you trying to reach?
If you know who they should call: You (will) want to call X. Would you like their number?

Additional phrases (Especially holding and wrong numbers)

Agreeing/Condoning:

Sure. (Is that ok?)

That's ok. (Is that ok?)
Not a problem. (I'm sorry...)
Don't worry about it. (I'm sorry...)
No trouble. (I'm sorry...)
Not to worry. (I'm sorry...)

Variations:

1 Getting through (Variation)

Receptionist forgets or confirms caller's information:

May I ask who is calling?
Could you please give/tell me your name again?
Where are you calling from?
What time is it there?

2 Transfer (Variation)

When someone is not available

(I'm afraid) X is not available at the moment
(I'm afraid) X isn't in...
(I'm afraid) X is out at the moment...

3 Transfer (Variation)

When a Transfer is not working:

(I'm afraid) The line is busy...
I'm sorry the line is busy. Would you like to wait, or would you like/prefer to call back later?
I'm sorry the line is (still) busy, would you like to keep waiting?

4 Hold (Variation)

Caller wants to try again later

(That's ok/all right,)I'll call back later.
(That's ok/all right,)I'll try again another day.
(That's ok/all right,)I'll try again later.
(That's ok/all right,)I'll try another time.

Goal 3) Take and Leave a Message

Phone Message: Skills & Situations Checklist

Taking a Message

- 1) When possible refer to the person by their name (if you have it, can pronounce it, and can remember it) .
- 2) Telling caller the person they wish to speak with is not present
- 3) Answer a question about when the person will be back.
- 4) Telling them when you are ready to take the message.
- 5) Getting and Checking the data.
- 6) Tell them you will deliver the message.
- 7) Hang up last.

Leaving a Message

- 1) Asking to leave a message:

- 2) Asking when the person will return. Checking if you need to leave a message or call back:
- 3) Identify yourself: your name, company
- 4) State the topic of the call. (e.g. placing an order, meeting, travel, etc.)
- 5) State your message
- 6) Common Messages
- 7) No message: you wish to call back
- 8) Get receptionist to repeat back your message to check it
- 9) Give your clients and customers the email option.
- 10) Say thank you
- 11) Hang up first

Taking a Message: Basic Phrases

1) When possible (if you have it, can pronounce it, and can remember it) refer to the person by their name):
Thank you for calling, Ms. X.

2) Telling the caller the person they wish to speak with is not present

A + B + C

Example:

I'm afraid that Ms. White is not at her desk at the moment. Would you like to leave a message?

A

(I am/I'm) sorry but...

I'm afraid that...

I'm terribly sorry...

B

X is not at her desk at the moment.

X is not available right now.

X is not here right now.

X is not in the office.

X just stepped out (of the office).

C

Would you like to leave a message?

Can I take a message?

Would you care to leave a message?

Would you like me to take a message?

I can take a message if you would like.

Would you like me to have them call you back?

3) Answer a question about when the person will be back:

Just a moment, let me find out.

He is gone for the day.

He will be back soon.

He will be back in a few minutes.

He will be away on business for an extended period.

He has the week off.

He will/should be back next week/tomorrow/this afternoon.

4) Telling them when you are ready to take the message

Just a moment (please) (I need a pen).
Ok, what is your message.
Ok, I am ready to take your message.
I am ready. What is your message.

5) Getting and Checking the data

Does she have your information?
Does she have your number?
Can I get your information please?
Do you know when she will/might/could/should be back in?
checking
Did you get all that?
Could you repeat that back to/for me?
Can I repeat that back to you (to confirm that it is correct)?

6) Tell them you will deliver the message:

I will make sure she gets your message.
I will give her your message.

7) Hang up last

Leaving a Message

1) Asking to leave a message:

Could/Can/May I leave a message?

2) Asking when the person will return. Checking if you need to leave a message or call back:

When will he/she be back (in)?

3) Identify yourself: your name, company

(Note: Don't use a title for yourself (Mr. Ms.). But "Dr." is ok.)

A + B

Example. This is Barry Goldwater calling from Coleman Inc. in America.

A

I am (first name) (last name),
My name is (first name) (last name),
This is (first name) (last name),

+

B

of (Company) in (Country).
from (Company) in (Country).
calling from (Company) in (Country)
I am calling from (Company) in (Country).
calling on behalf of (Company) in (Country)

4) State the topic of the call. (e.g. placing an order, meeting, travel, etc.)

I am calling about...

I am calling regarding...

This is about...

This regards...

5) State your message

Please tell her/him (that)...

The message is...

6) Common Messages

Please tell X to Y.

Could you tell X to Y.

Please have X Y. (e.g. Please have her call me back.)

Please tell X (that) Y. (Please tell Tom that I need X.)

Could please have him call me?

or

Please tell him to call me/give me a call?

Could you tell her to call me when she gets in?

Please tell her to call me back.

Please have her call me back.

Could you have her call me back when she gets in.

(Could you) (Please) Call me back when she gets in.

Please have him get back to me about X (the meeting, the shipment, the inspection).

Could you tell her I have a question about X (the meeting, the shipment, the inspection).

Could you ask him to send me (the/a/an) X.

7) No message: you wish to call back

I'll call back then.

I will call back.

8) Get receptionist to repeat back your message to check it

Could you please repeat that back to me?

Can you repeat that back for me please?

9) Give your clients and customers the email option.

Would it be easier to get back to me by email?

10) Say thank you

Thank you.

Thank you very much.

Thank you very much for your time.

Sorry to trouble you.

Thank you for your help.

Thank you, you have been very helpful.

11) Hang up first

4) Wrong Number

It is certainly the wrong number: I'm sorry, you have the wrong number.

It is likely the wrong number, or you are being polite: I'm sorry, I think you have the wrong number.

Uncertain/Maybe the wrong number: I'm sorry, (I think) you may/might have the wrong number.

Who/(What number) were you trying to reach?

If you know who they should call: You (will) want to call X. Would you like their number?

Additional phrases (Especially holding and wrong numbers)

Agreeing/Condoning:

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Variations:

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What time is it there?

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3 Transfer (Variation)

When a Transfer is not working:

(I'm afraid) The line is busy...

I'm sorry the line is busy. Would you like to wait, or would you like/prefer to call back later?

I'm sorry the line is (still) busy, would you like to keep waiting?

4 Hold (Variation)

Caller wants to try again later

(That's ok/all right,)I'll call back later.

(That's ok/all right,)I'll try again another day.

(That's ok/all right,)I'll try again later.

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Wait a minute.

Just a minute.

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Caller Goodbye Phrases:

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- Have a nice day. Goodbye
- Thank you very much for your help. Good bye.
- Thank you for your time. Goodbye.